a single variable. Object is an instance of either a built-in or user defined class. In addition to properties, class defines functionality associated with data.

PHP is an object oriented language, although it does not have to be used as one, since most PHP functions are not object oriented. In object oriented programming, a class is a definition of an object, whereas an object is an instance of an object, meaning that from one class you can create many objects.

A class is defined by using the class keyword, followed by the name of the class and a pair of curly braces ({}). Classes are nothing without objects! We can create multiple objects from a class. Each object has all the properties and methods defined in the class, but they will have different property values. Objects of a class is created using the new keyword.

6.1 PHP OBJECTS AND CLASSES

The basic building blocks of object-oriented programming are classes and objects. Understanding object and class and the differences between object and class is very important before we can dive into object-oriented programming approach.

6.1.1 PHP Objects vs. Classes

Remember

Notice that the getter and setter names, match the associated property name.

In the real world, an object has its own characteristics and behaviors. We can group similar objects with the same characteristics and behaviors in into one class. So we can say that a class is a blueprint of the objects. See the image below:

